

Safe payments for new lithium companies

An escrow on Solana for lithium sales between new producers and buyers they don't know. Built in Jujuy, Argentina. Recorded on camera, with short screen cuts taken from the devnet demo recording.

1 · THE PROBLEM · 0:00–0:35

We are JuLit — four builders from Jujuy, Argentina, inside the Lithium Triangle.

Big lithium companies sell to their own partners.¹ But new, small producers sell to buyers they don't know.

Argosy Minerals, in Salta, sold 20 tonnes to a buyer in Hong Kong. The buyer paid everything before the ship was loaded.² All the risk was on the buyer.

A letter of credit is expensive and slow,³ and banks reject small companies more often.⁴ So many of them pay with their own money, with no protection.⁵

2 · THE SOLUTION · 0:35–1:05

JuLit is an escrow on Solana for these sales.

[Cut 1 · Producer creates a lot · ~7 s]

The producer creates a lot for one buyer, with a ship-by date and a window to confirm.

[Cut 2 · Buyer deposits dUSDC · ~7 s]

The buyer deposits USDC into the escrow.

[Cut 3 · Producer marks shipped · ~7 s]

The producer ships, and records the hash of the bill of lading on-chain.

[Cut 4 · Buyer confirms → producer paid · ~7 s]

The buyer checks the lithium and confirms. The producer gets paid.

3 · WHY IT IS SAFE · 1:05–1:30

Nobody gets stuck. If the producer never ships, the buyer gets a full refund. If the buyer never answers, the producer can claim the payment.

The fee is frozen on-chain when the buyer deposits, and it can never be more than 2 percent.

[Cut 5 · Solana Explorer, fund_lot and redeem_lot txs · label "devnet · test dUSDC" · ~6 s]

Each step costs less than one cent.⁶ It runs today on Solana devnet. These are the real transactions.

4 · BUSINESS & VALIDATION · 1:30–1:45

We charge 1 percent, only when the payment is settled.

5 · NEXT & CLOSE · 1:45–2:00

Next: our first pilot lot with a producer from northern Argentina.

With JuLit, the buyer is protected if nothing ships, and the producer ships knowing the money is there. We are JuLit. Thank you.

SOURCES

1. Lithium Argentina AG, Exhibit 99.1 filed with the SEC (2026) — Cauchari-Olaroz (Jujuy) is owned 44.8% by Lithium Argentina, 46.7% by Ganfeng and 8.5% by JEMSE; "Both parties are entitled to offtake in proportion to their ownership interests." sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1440972/000106299326004563/exhibit99-1.htm
2. Argosy Minerals (ASX: AGY), *Lithium Carbonate Spot Sales Contract*, March 2025 — 20 t of battery-quality lithium carbonate from the Rincon project (Salta) sold to a Hong Kong based chemical company, FOB Buenos Aires, "requiring a 30% deposit and the 70% balance required prior to ship loading". argosyminerals.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2025/03/2861224.pdf
3. U.S. International Trade Administration, *Letter of Credit* — letters of credit "can be labor-intensive and relatively expensive due to bank fees" and their documents "are detailed and prone to errors and discrepancies". trade.gov/letter-credit
4. Asian Development Bank, *2023 Trade Finance Gaps, Growth, and Jobs Survey* (ADB Brief 256) — in 2022, SMEs submitted 38% of trade finance applications but received 45% of rejections; reasons include "lack of transaction history or long-term relationships with bankers". adb.org/sites/default/files/publication/906596/adb-brief-256-2023-trade-finance-gaps-growth-jobs-survey.pdf
5. Asian Development Bank, *2021 Trade Finance Gaps, Growth, and Jobs Survey* (ADB Brief 192) — "Among SMEs who were initially rejected and sought alternative financing, 40% used their own funds." adb.org/sites/default/files/publication/739286/adb-brief-192-trade-finance-gaps-jobs-survey.pdf
6. Solana Docs, *Fees* — base fee of 5,000 lamports (0.000005 SOL) per signature; under one US cent at any SOL price below \$2,000. solana.com/docs/core/fees